driven trading, real-time audit trails, broker-level safeguards, adversarial red-teaming and AI-led surveillance. Taken together, it marks a shift from reactive oversight to system-wide risk management. Markets may increasingly need monitoring—and, if required, stabilisation—at machine speed. That is a profound doctrinal change.

> **AI changes the speed, scale and sophistication with which risks may be exploited. You can't bring a sword to a gunfight. We need to defend using smart AI tools**
>
> **—KUNAL NANDWANI**
> *Co-founder, uTrade Solutions*

Yet experts stress Mythos is not only a warning, but also a call for digital defence. During geopolitical incidents such as Operation Sindoor, Kamdar notes how some firms faced 1,000-2,000 attacks per second, making manual response impossible. Automation became essential. "AI must be used to manage and fight the risks posed by AI." That principle now runs through discussions around "DevSecOps" (development, security and operations), i.e. integrating security testing at every stage of the software development process, and "findings lifecycle management"—the speed at which vulnerabilities can be identified and fixed before exploitation. "Mythos brings a new set of vulnerabilities and unprecedented challenges, and the industry can no longer afford to be complacent," says Sugandh Saxena, CEO, Fintech Association for Consumer Empowerment (FACE), a self-regulatory body for the fintech sector.

The Bigger Challenge

For banks and insurers, says Sony Anthony, partner and head, cyber defence, at KPMG India, the collapse in response windows changes everything. "Previously, it could take up to 2.5 years for a vulnerability to be exploited; now, with Mythos, this timeframe has collapsed to about 20 hours." To address these risks, Anthony says organisations should consider implementing faster patch cycles, bigger budgets and deeper use of automation.

Vinayak Godse, CEO of the Data Security Council of India (DSCI), argues that the response must go beyond patching. "The world for which we built current security systems no longer exists." His prescription includes aggressively testing internet-facing applications, reducing attack surfaces and redesigning architecture through techniques such as micro-segmentation. "Until now, finding a zero day was elite work," he says. "That barrier is now democratised."

WHAT CORPORATES MUST DO

Big enterprises

- ↘ **Adopt a Zero Trust Architecture that treats every network access request as untrusted by default and grants only the minimum necessary access to users and systems**
- ↘ **Enforce multi-factor authentication across internet-facing assets, critical services, third-party integrations and cloud management consoles**
- ↘ **Implement rapid patching to minimise the time to apply updates across internet-facing systems, browsers and operating systems**

MSMEs

- ↘ **Keep all operating systems, browsers and applications up to date**
- ↘ **Leverage managed security services for patching and continuous monitoring**
- ↘ **Remove or isolate unmaintained, legacy or unused web applications and systems from the network**

That may be the most unsettling line in this debate. CERT-In has urged firms to elevate alert levels, reduce exposed attack surfaces and adopt AI-enabled defensive tools. It has even advised monitoring outbound traffic to AI services and training security teams to detect how AI-augmented attackers operate. FACE has urged members to accelerate patching, improve zero-day intelligence and ringfence critical systems. The Indian Banks' Association is similarly focused on hardening payment rails. But experts say India also needs something broader: sovereign cyber capability, deeper engagement with frontier software providers and a long-term national cyber defence strategy. That means not merely reacting to frontier AI but building capability to shape the defensive frontier itself.